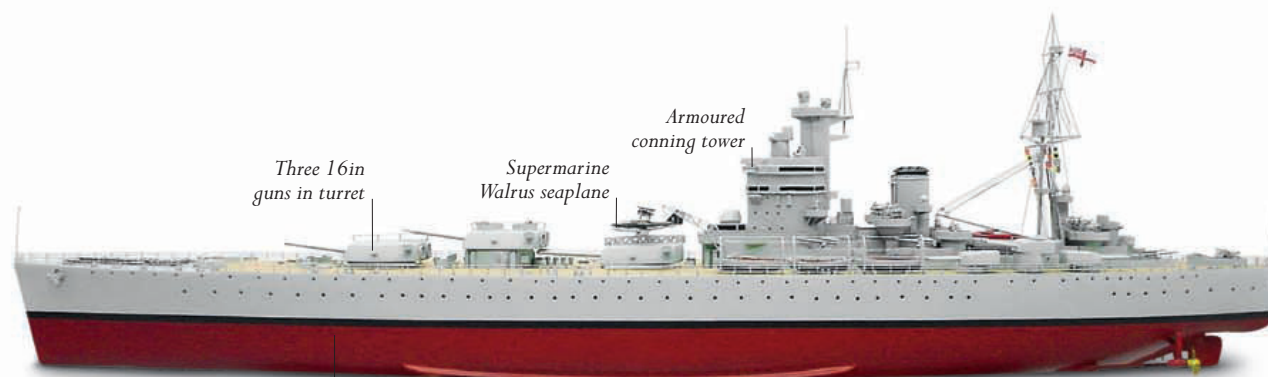




◀ HMS RODNEY

Commissioned	1927	Origin	UK
Displacement	45,200 tons		
Length	216.4m (710ft)		
Top speed	23 knots		

Built to the limits imposed by the Washington Naval Treaty, *Rodney* and its sister-ship *Nelson* were characterized by the unconventional layout of their main armament – their 16in guns were all located forward, in three triple turrets.

14in thick armour belt at the waterline



▲ BISMARCK

Commissioned	1940	Origin	Germany
Displacement	50,900 tons		
Length	248m (814ft)		
Top speed	29 knots		

The pride of the Kriegsmarine, *Bismarck* and its sister-ship *Tirpitz* achieved iconic status. Both ships acted as a deterrent that drained British naval resources, although *Bismarck*'s effective action was limited to the destruction of HMS *Hood*. It was sunk in 1941 after being holed by British torpedo bombers.

11in thick armour belt at the waterline

Twin rudders

90mm anti-aircraft gun

▼ VITTORIO VENETO

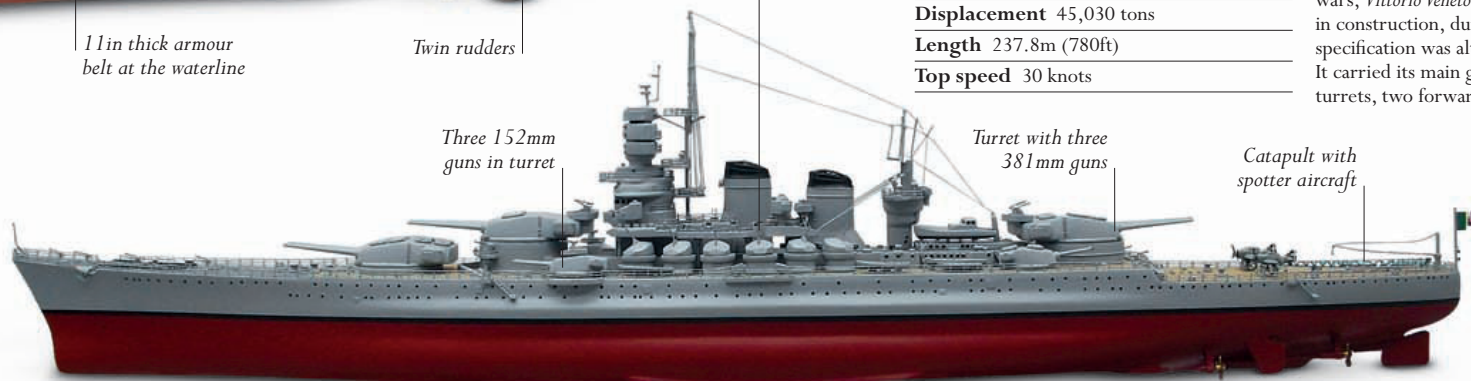
Commissioned	1940	Origin	Italy
Displacement	45,030 tons		
Length	237.8m (780ft)		
Top speed	30 knots		

One of just three fast battleships built for the Regia Marina between the world wars, *Vittorio Veneto* spent over five years in construction, during which time its specification was altered significantly. It carried its main guns in triple turrets, two forward and one aft.

Three 152mm guns in turret

Turret with three 381mm guns

Catapult with spotter aircraft



Catapult for launching spotter aircraft

◀ USS NORTH CAROLINA

Commissioned	1941	Origin	US
Displacement	44,380 tons		
Length	222.1m (729ft)		
Top speed	28 knots		

North Carolina and its sister-ship *Washington* marked a departure in US battleship design when they were built. They were bigger and much faster than those laid down at the end of World War I, and were equipped with much more powerful armament. *North Carolina*, "The Showboat", is preserved at Wilmington in its home state.



▼ YAMATO

Commissioned	1941	Origin	Japan
Displacement	69,990 tons		
Length	263m (863ft)		
Top speed	27 knots		

Yamato and its sister-ship *Musashi* were the biggest battleships ever constructed, and mounted the most powerful armament. However, both succumbed to air attack. Another of the same class, *Shinano*, was completed as an aircraft carrier, but was sunk before being completed by a US submarine, the *Archerfish*.

Three 18.1in guns in turret

Three 6.1in guns in turret

